TRANSITIONAL SEMI-ALLOPHONIC SPIRANTIZATION IN TIBERIAN HEBREW

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ALLOPHONIC VARIATION

- English allophone /p/ → [p] or [p^h]
  - *pit* [‘p^hɪt]
  - *spit* [‘spɪt]
- /p, t, k/ → { [p^h, t^h, k^h] / #__
  { [p^h, t^h, k^h] / v__ˊV



BGDKPT בגדכפת

Following a consonant (C__)	Allophones	Following a vowel (V__)
ב ג ד כ פ ת		ב ג ד כ פ ת
		
[b, g, d, k, p, t]		[v, ɣ, ð, x, f, θ]
ג	[g]	ג
ד	[d]	ד
כ	[k]	כ
פ	[p]	פ
ת	[t]	ת
ב	[b]	ב
ג	[ɣ]	ג
ד	[ð]	ד
כ	[x]	כ
פ	[f]	פ
ת	[θ]	ת
ב	[v]	ב

SPANISH ALLOPHONES

- /b → { [β] / V__
  - *brazo* [braso] (“arm”)
  - *abrazo* [aβraso] (“hug”)
- /g/ → { [ɣ] / V__
  - *gorra* [gora] (“cap”)
  - *agarrar* [aɣarar] (“to grab”)
- /d/ → { [ð] / V__
  - *andar* [andar\] (“to go”)
  - *añadir* [aɲaðir] (“to add”)
  - *una gorra* [una ɣora] (“a cap”)
  - *dedo* [deðo] (“finger”)

BASIC RULES OF ALLOPHONIC SPIRANTIZATION



1. If the consonant in question is immediately preceded by a vowel—including across word boundaries where juncture is present—then it is pronounced as a fricative.
2. In all other cases, it is pronounced as a plosive.

ALLOPHONIC COMPLICATIONS

- Masoretic *shwa*
  - Mobile shwa vs. quiescent shwa vs. shwa medium
  - “There is a rather common circular argument that, since a simple shva followed by a plosive must be quiescent, the Bet in שַׁרְבִיט must therefore be preceded by a vocal shva.” (Joüon-Muraoka, §8c, 48)
- *Resh* (ר)
  - וַיֶּחֶרְדוּ [wayːaħerðu] (“they trembled,” Gen. 42:28)
  - קִרְבוּ [kirvu] (imperative masculine plural “come near,” Ex. 16:9)
  - בִּרְכָתִי [birxaθi] (“my blessing,” Lev. 25:21)
  - וְלִרְכֻשָׁם [wəlirxuʃam] (“and for their livestock,” Num. 35:3)
  - וְכִרְבִיבִים [wəxirvivim] (“and like showers,” Deut. 32:2)

ELIDED VOWELS

- וַיֶּחֱרְדוּ [way:aħerðu]
  - yeḥĕrədû > yeḥerdû
- קִרְבוּ [kirvu]
  - qərəbû > qirbû
- בִּרְכָתִי [birxaθi] (“my blessing,” Lev. 25:21)
  - bərəkātî > birkātî

- מַלְכֵי [malxeɪ] (“kings of,” Gen. 17:16)
- עַבְדֵי [ʕavðeɪ] (“servants of,” Gen. 21:25)
- בְּכַנְפֵיהֶם [bəxanfeɪhem] (“with their wings,” Ex. 25:20)
- אַלְפֵי [ʔalfeɪ] (“thousands of,” Num. 10:36)
- בְּעַרְבֹת [bəʕarvoθ] (“in the plains of,” Deut. 34:8)

/katabu/ > [kaθvu]
but
/yakatov/ > [yixtov] not *[yixθov]

WITH PREPOSITION OR CONJUNCTION

- וּנְגֹעַ [unɣoaʕ] (“and to touch,” Ex. 19:12)
  - [wə] + [nəɣoaʕ]
- לִצְבֹא [litsvoʔ] (“to serve,” Num. 4:23)
  - [lə] + [tsəvoʔ]
- לִסְבֹב [lisvov] (“to go around,” Num. 21:4)
  - [lə] + [səvov]



MINIMAL PAIRS

English

- /b/ and /v/
  - *bat* [bæt]
  - *vat* [væt]
- /t/ and /θ/
  - *bat* [bæt]
  - *bath* [bæθ]

Hebrew

- /t/ and /θ/
  - לָקַחַתְּ [lakaħat]
  - לָקַחַת [lakaħaθ]

CONCLUSION

